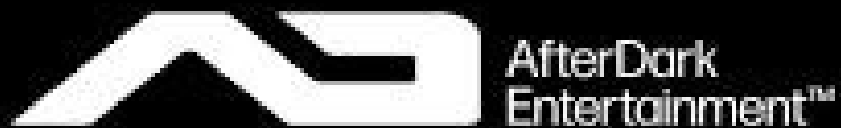


Branding Guide



Prepared by Thomas Brown

TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 GOALS
PG 01

02 BRANDING AVENUES
PG 02

03 BRANDING IDEAS
PG 03

04 CONTENT IDEAS
PG 04

05 POTENTIAL COLLABS
PG 05

06 STRENGTHS/WEAKNESS
PG 06-07

BROAD GOALS

- Establish Afterdark as a premier promotion powerhouse in Central Texas—operating independently from The Marc while remaining deeply connected to the regional scene.
- Be recognized as curators of the DJ/Electronic scene in Texas, shaping the culture rather than just participating in it.
- • Position Afterdark as the hub for DJ culture in Central Texas, leading the charge in the region’s growing EDM movement.
- Maintain an event-focused approach, ensuring Afterdark is known for throwing the biggest and most high-energy EDM events in Central Texas. (Core Pillar)
- Create an emotional connection with the audience that extends beyond just event promotions—cultivate a true community around Afterdark.
- Become synonymous with “EDM culture” in Austin/Central Texas, making Afterdark the go-to brand for fans of the genre.
- Shine a spotlight on up-and-coming DJs and producers in Austin, giving them a platform to grow.
- Play a key role in elevating Austin into a national EDM hotspot, on par with destinations like Vegas, Tulum, and Miami.
- Refine branding, aesthetic, and core elements to establish a stronger and more recognizable identity.
- Develop a brand personality that resonates deeply with fans, making Afterdark more than just an event promoter.

SPECIFIC GOALS

- Build a strong social media presence centered around throwing the biggest EDM events in Central Texas—leveraging BTS content, fan interactions, and trend participation to stay ahead of the curve.
- Engage fans on a deeper level beyond event promotion, fostering a tight-knit community around Afterdark.
- Leverage strategic partnerships and current influence to position Afterdark at the forefront of the EDM scene in Texas.
- Use existing artist bookings to showcase what Afterdark does behind the scenes—elevating brand credibility and authority.
- Utilize the artists performing at The Marc as a promotional tool to further establish Afterdark as an EDM powerhouse.
- Capitalize on Austin’s growing EDM culture to push local DJs to the forefront, providing them a platform to grow into regional and national acts.
- Tap into local social trends (e.g., run clubs, morning raves) to broaden audience reach, increase engagement, and foster deeper emotional investment in the brand.

BRANDING AVENUES

AfterDark Entertainment



Core Pillars

Throwing the biggest shows in Central TX

EDM Focused

How do we want the AD to be perceived?

Local Scene Curators & Tastemakers



Position AD as the pulse of what's hot in TX EDM

Fan Experience & Community



Position as Interactive, Immersive Brand, Prioritize Fan Engagement

Industry Insiders



Position AD as the bridge between fans and BTS world of Event Prod.

BRANDING IDEAS

1. Local Scene Curators and Tastemakers

Easy/Inexpensive

- Focus on showcasing emerging local acts that produce their own music
- Refocus Merch Efforts towards Rave Culture (Pashminas, Sunglasses, Bandanas etc)

Moderate

- Backstage Media for Local EDM Festivals -ill Fest, Freaky Deaky etc
- Leaning into industry trends/Club Culture Shift, Collab with local event organizers - Day Raves, Run Club Raves etc

Expensive/Challenging

- Create Signature Visual Identity for The Marc - ie Kinetic Chandelier at Omnia, Curved/Ceiling Video Wall at Concourse

2. Fan Experience and Community

Easy/Inexpensive

- Target EDM/Electronic Scene Specifically (Ensure all branding, content, and partnerships align with the EDM audience)
- Push Content About the Fan Experience (Street interviews, GRWM, post-show highlights, crowd reaction videos)

Moderate

- Fan Experience Giveaways
- Local EDM Festival Activations

Expensive/ Challenging

- Future SXSW Official Showcases
- Surprise Popups at high traffic times in Austin - ie Experts Only on Bourbon Street

3. Industry Insiders

Easy/Inexpensive

- BTS of Event Production
- Provide insight to aspiring industry professionals via podcast style interviews with industry leaders

Moderate

- Develop AD app/Website to curate local events for Austin/San Marcos
- TX EDM Festival/River Fest Planning BTS .

CONTENT IDEAS

1. Local Scene Curators/Tastemakers

Easy/Inexpensive

- Monthly Local Event Roundup (Highlight upcoming shows, festival news, and underground events)
- Afterdark Playlist and Weekly EDM Music Roundup on TikTok (Music curation to keep the audience engaged with the scene)
- AfterDark Discord Community - Brings whole community together in a interactive way

Moderate

- Artist Interviews - Interview Artists Pre or Post Show - ex Space Miami Interview Cassian
- Collab Posts with Artists Pre/Post Show (Cross-promotion with artists before and after their sets)
- Collab with Local Curators and throw events with the growing Austin Scene - Run Club Rave (Diplo), Secret Disco, Mushroom Cowboy

2. Fan Experience & Community

Easy/Inexpensive

- Fan Street Interviews Pre/Post Show (Capture attendee excitement and reactions to enhance event branding)
- Show Recaps Short/Long Form (Highlighting key moments from major shows)
- GRWM for a Show at The Marc, Festival/Rave Outfits (Featuring concert influencers like Ali Pent, Jamie Lyn, Concert Queen)
- Fan Experience Giveaways (Meet and greets with artists, showcased via Instagram and TikTok)
 - Candid Crowd Reactions - Close Up Shots of people the Crowd
 - Sound Check w/ The DJ - Empty Room/Full Room
 - Staff Event Picks Monthly

Moderate

- Live Streamed and Recorded Sets for Social Media (Boiler Room-style mixes with major and local acts) - Licensing Hurdles
 - Unique Shots of the Venue in Content - 360 Cam, Birds eye view up and above

3. Industry Insiders

Easy/Inexpensive

- Industry Side of BTS Highlighting Event Production (Show booking agents, tour managers, production teams at work)
- Podcast-Style Interviews with Industry Professionals (Discussions on industry trends, networking, and major event collaborations)

Moderate

- BTS Interviews with Artists and Their Teams Pre/Post Show (Long-form and short-form vlog-style content)

POTENTIAL COLLABORATORS

- Day Rave/Local Players - Mushroom Cowboy, 512 Coffee Club, Secret Disco Society
- Rawdawg Run Club - DJ/Run Club Event (Gym Shark Partnered already)
- When Where What Austin
- Local Social Media Influencers - Jamie Lyn, Concert Queen etc.
- Local EDM Festivals - Ill Fest, Freaky Deaky etc.
- West Campus Music - Solid size event company booking shows on UT Campus

STRENGTHS

- **Established Reputation** – Already booking some of the biggest artists in the scene, drawing in acts that people genuinely care about.
- **Extensive Industry Network** – Strong connections with industry professionals and key organizers (e.g., Ill Fest, River Fest), providing leverage for bigger opportunities.
- **Prime Geographic Positioning** – Operating in a naturally growing EDM market with increasing demand for DJs and electronic music events.
- **Recognized Event Authority** – Well-known in the industry as a leading event company with a track record of successful, large-scale productions.
- **Strong Social Media Presence** – Large and engaged social following, providing direct access to a dedicated EDM audience.
- **Strategic Market Positioning** – Dominance in San Marcos while maintaining flexibility in Austin through Nova, DMC, and Mayfair, allowing for expansion and adaptability.
- **Key Industry Partnerships** – Already collaborating with major players like Live Nation Concerts, C3, and Illfest, solidifying credibility and access to bigger opportunities.
- **Trusted Curators in the Scene** – Built a strong foundation in the EDM community through consistent involvement with The Marc, Mayfair, and other key venues.
- **Proven Track Record with Unique Initiatives** – Successfully launched creative grassroots efforts like AD Angles and the Street Team, demonstrating innovation in engagement and branding.

WEAKNESSES

- **Lack of Defined Brand Identity** – Currently limited to posting show flyers and event photos, without a clear brand image, voice, or goal, resulting in low emotional investment from the audience.
- **Limited Public Recognition** – While well-known within the industry, public and regional awareness of Afterdark remains low, making it difficult to stand out in the scene.
- **Invisible Behind-the-Scenes Work** – The team is heavily involved in planning and executing major events, but there's limited public awareness of what goes into creating these experiences. The brand doesn't showcase how it throws the biggest events, only the events themselves.
- **Corporate Vibe Without Local Scene Integration** – The current branding comes off as just another big event promoter (similar to a Live Nation conglomerate), rather than an active force shaping the local EDM scene. This makes Afterdark seem “too big” and disconnected from its grassroots audience.
- **No Talent Development Presence** – Afterdark is seen as an event organizer, not a scene influencer, lacking efforts to develop or break local talent. This creates a one-dimensional image of only throwing shows, rather than pushing the culture forward.
- **No Recognizable Face or Personality** – The brand lacks a distinct personality, image, or key figure that fans can relate to, making it harder to build a strong emotional connection with the audience.
- **Limited Talent Breaking Through** – There's a bottleneck for DJs not producing or releasing original music, making it difficult to establish new regional or national talent under the Afterdark umbrella.